



Sony facing lawsuit over Linux on PS3

The Sony PlayStation 3 emerged as a popular building block for cheap Linux-based supercomputing clusters, for users like the Folding@Home project and the US Air Force. However, Sony's "security-related" move to block installation of alternative OSes like Linux on the PS3 has prompted unhappy users to file a class-action lawsuit against the company. More at: <http://goo.gl/TUK3>



Arch Linux 2010.05 arrives

The Arch Linux project's official 2010.05 installation images are out. The release features the 2.6.33.4 Linux kernel; updated ISO files (isohybrid) that can be burned to CDs and to other media, such as USB flash drives; support for Virtio and PXE booting; Memtest updates and a number of bug fixes. The AIF (Arch Linux Installation Framework) installer includes several updates, and "more than half of the packages in core are now xz compressed." More at: <http://goo.gl/TeM>

CentOS 5.5 released

CentOS 5.5, based on the upstream release of RHEL 5.5, has recently been announced. All upstream repositories have been combined into one, to make it easier for end users to work with. The announcement mail is at <http://goo.gl/EFg6> and the Release Notes are at <http://goo.gl/M5bP>

SCO files motion for judgement as a matter of law, or for a trial

SCO has filed a "renewed" motion for judgement "as a matter of law" asking the judge to rule over the heads of the jury and decide that the jury "simply got it wrong" when it ruled that SCO didn't get the copyrights in 1995 from Novell. Alternatively, they'd like a new trial. More at: <http://goo.gl/1zQc>

The Defensive Patent License makes patents less evil for open source

Two law professors from UC Berkeley have come up with a novel idea—a Defensive Patent License to protect open source developers from patent bullies. They hope the DPL can address the objections FOSS developers have

with patents, the way the GPL addressed them for copyright.

Open source developers notoriously shy away from pursuing software patents, which are an ugly concept for them. However, without patents of their own, FOSS developers are vulnerable to patent trolls and bullies. The DPL's creators, Jason Schultz and Jennifer Urban, say the licence is intended to bring about "a distributed network of patent owners," who grant a standardised licence to others in the network who "commit their patents to 100 per cent defensive purposes." More at: <http://goo.gl/jGEj>



Android outsells iPhone in the US

Apple fans laughed at the idea that Apple sued HTC (and specifically targeted Android) because they were afraid of Android's rising popularity. They may need to think again: in the first quarter of 2010, Android took second place in the US (in market-share), beating out the iPhone by a wide margin. More at: <http://goo.gl/02uv>



FSF launches site for free OpenOffice extensions

The Free Software Foundation has announced that it will maintain a list of Free Software extensions for the OpenOffice.org office suite. FSF executive director Peter Brown said, "OpenOffice.org is free software, and an important contribution to the free software community. However, the program offers the user a library of extensions, and some of them are proprietary. Distributing OpenOffice.org in the usual way has the effect of offering users the non-free extensions too." The FSF hopes that the replacement extension library will let users easily find and use Free Software extensions by "making a simple configuration change," without changing any of the OpenOffice code. More at: <http://goo.gl/bGN5>

